

Experiment 1

Aim:

- A. Analyze 4 social media platforms.
- B. Explore 3 latest tools and APIs for social media analytics.
- C. Understand engagement metrics.
- D. Discuss applications of SMA in business using tools like Google Analytics 4 and Netlytic

Theory:

A. Analysis of Four Social Media Platforms

1. Discord:

Discord was started to solve a big problem: how to communicate with friends worldwide while playing games online. It's a home for communities of any size, but it's most widely used by small and active groups of people who talk regularly. Discord is used by everyone from local hiking clubs, to art communities, to study groups. Discord has millions of people creating places for their friends and communities, talking for upwards of 4 hours per day on the platform. Discord is now where the world talks, hangs out and builds relationships. Discord lets anyone create a space to find belonging—just like it did for Jason and Stan. People love Discord because it's a home for all their communities and groups of friends. It's a place where they can be themselves and spend time with other people who share their interests and hobbies

2. X (formerly Twitter)

X, formerly known as Twitter, is a social media platform that revolutionized online communication by introducing the concept of microblogging. Originally launched in 2006, it became widely popular for its real-time sharing of short text-based posts, known as tweets, limited to 280 characters. Over time, it expanded to include multimedia capabilities like images, videos, and live streaming. Renamed as "X" in 2023 under Elon Musk's leadership, the platform aims to evolve into an "everything app," integrating a wide range of services beyond social networking, such as payment solutions and e-commerce functionalities. X remains a hub for sharing news, engaging in public discourse, and connecting with communities worldwide, emphasizing speed and accessibility in the digital era.

3. Youtube

YouTube is an online streaming platform that provides its users with a personalized environment to watch videos across the globe. It allows users to track their engagement of each video across the platform. The creator-audience engagement is developed by the provision of a comment

section, likes, subscribe option, donate option, merchandise, and more. Youtube is accessible to anyone who has an internet connection. It acts as a diverse platform that has different types of content including entertainment, news, vlogs, educational content, and more. Users can download the videos online and can watch them later in offline mode. YouTube also features a robust recommendation system designed to enhance user experience by suggesting videos tailored to individual interests. The recommendations are presented on the homepage, in the "Up Next" section, and on the "Explore" page. Additionally, YouTube provides personalized playlists like "Watch Later" and "Trending," helping users easily discover new videos and stay updated with popular content. YouTube stands as a perfect platform to stream videos and reach out to audiences situated in any corner of the world.

4. Instagram

Instagram is a popular social media platform that allows users to share photos, videos, and stories. Launched in 2010, it enables individuals, brands, and influencers to connect with others through visual content. Users can follow accounts, engage with posts by liking, commenting, and sharing, as well as explore a wide range of curated content through hashtags and the "Explore" page. Instagram also provides a recommendation system that suggests posts, accounts, and content based on users' interests and interactions. The platform uses algorithms that analyze user behaviour, such as likes, comments, follows, and time spent on specific types of posts, to recommend relevant content in the "Explore" tab and the "Reels" section. Instagram's recommendation system also adapts to users' preferences over time, ensuring that the content displayed aligns with their evolving tastes and engagement patterns. Instagram also offers features like Direct Messaging, Reels, and Shopping, making it a versatile platform for personal expression, marketing, and community engagement.

B. Three Latest Tools and APIs for social media analytics

1. Discord

a) MEE6

MEE6 is one of the most widely used Discord bots, offering a suite of features to enhance server management, engagement, and customization. It includes moderation tools, automatic notifications, and levelling systems, making it a go-to tool for community management and interaction.

○ Key Features –

- Auto-moderation, custom rules enforcement, banning, and kicking users.

- Encourages engagement with a point system based on user activity, allowing users to level up and unlock rewards
 - Tracks user activity, message volume, and engagement patterns within the server.
- **Use Case** – MEE6 is ideal for boosting community engagement through its levelling system, encouraging users to be more active by rewarding participation. It's also widely used for streamlining server moderation, automatically filtering inappropriate content and enforcing custom rules, making it easier for admins to maintain a positive environment. Additionally, its notification system is perfect for keeping members informed about events or new content.

b) Statbot

Statbot is an advanced analytics bot for Discord, designed to provide in-depth insights into server activity. It offers detailed statistics and visual representations of user engagement, message flow, and overall server trends, helping server admins understand their community better and improve interactions.

- **Key Features** –
 - Provides detailed reports on user activity, including messages, voice participation, and server joins/leaves.
 - Tracks trends in engagement over time, offering insights into peak activity periods.
 - Generates easy-to-read graphs and charts to visualize data for better decision-making.
- **Use Case** – Statbot is perfect for server admins who want to deeply analyze server activity and engagement trends. It helps identify periods of high user activity, optimizing when to schedule events or content. Statbot also provides a detailed breakdown of individual user and channel performance, helping admins tailor their community strategy and ensure higher engagement levels across the board.

c) Discords Insights

Discord Insights is a built-in tool provided by Discord to help server owners access native analytics. It delivers insights into user activity, message volume, member growth, and retention rates directly within the Discord app, without the need for third-party bots

- **Key Features** –
 - Tracks user activity, including messages and interactions within different channels.
 - Monitors server growth, showing how many users are joining or leaving over time.
 - Analyzes message volume to identify periods of high or low engagement.
 - Provides retention metrics to see how well the server retains active members.

- **Use Case** – Discord Insights is perfect for server owners who want to monitor their server's growth and activity without using third-party bots. It helps identify when members are most engaged, how well the server retains users, and where improvements can be made. Admins can use this data to refine content or event planning, ensuring they maintain an active and engaged community.

2. Letterboxd

3. Youtube

a) **YouTube Data API v3**

- **Overview** – The YouTube Data API v3 provides developers access to YouTube content and user interactions. It allows for fetching video details, comments, playlists, and analytics data.
- **Key Features** –
 - Retrieve video performance metrics (views, likes, comments).
 - Fetch channel data (subscribers, video statistics).
 - Search YouTube videos and playlists.
- **Use Case** – Ideal for developers and marketers who need to automate the process of fetching YouTube data for detailed performance analysis and reporting.

b) **YouTube Studio Analytics**

- **Overview** – YouTube Studio is the native platform for creators to manage their channels and view in-depth analytics. This includes views, audience demographics, and revenue data.
- **Key Features** –

- Provides insights into video performance, including watch time, top traffic sources, and audience retention.
- Audience demographics and engagement data.
- Real-time data on views, likes, comments, and shares.
- **Use Case** – Ideal for creators to optimize content based on detailed insights and audience behaviour.

c) **Social Blade**

- **Overview** – Social Blade offers an independent analytics platform that tracks YouTube channel statistics and forecasts growth trends based on data.
- **Key Features** –
 - Provides insights into subscriber count, video views, and estimated earnings.
 - Channel growth analysis with visualized statistics over time.
 - Ranking of channels by categories such as gaming, beauty, tech, etc.
- **Use Case** – Perfect for creators who want to track their growth, compare themselves with competitors, and assess their performance with benchmarks.

4. Instagram

I. Instagram Graph API

- **Overview:** The Instagram Graph API provides detailed insights into Instagram business and creator accounts. This API gives access to content and audience engagement data, including metrics on posts, stories, and followers.
- **Key Features:**
 - Insights into user engagement, impressions, reach, and demographic data.
 - Data about Instagram Stories performance (replies, exits, shares).
 - Allows publishing and scheduling posts through integrated tools.
- **Use Case:** Used by businesses and creators to access detailed analytics for Instagram posts and stories, track performance, and understand audience behaviour.

II. Iconosquare

- **Overview:** Iconosquare is a social media analytics tool focused on Instagram, providing in-depth metrics for posts, stories, and follower interactions. It offers performance reports, engagement rates, and growth tracking.
- **Key Features:**
 - Provides detailed analytics on post engagement, hashtag performance, and audience growth.
 - Tracks Instagram Stories metrics, such as swipe-up actions and replies.

- Competitor benchmarking and influencer marketing tracking.
- **Use Case:** Ideal for marketers and agencies that need to track engagement and growth across Instagram profiles, analyze competitors, and optimize content strategy.

2. Hootsuite Analytics

- **Overview:** Hootsuite is a popular social media management platform that also provides powerful analytics tools for Instagram. It tracks engagement, audience insights, and content performance across multiple platforms, including Instagram.
- **Key Features:**
 - Provides social media reporting for Instagram posts, Stories, and engagement.
 - Audience insights, including location, age, and interests.
 - Customizable reports and cross-platform performance comparison.
- **Use Case:** Perfect for brands and agencies managing multiple social accounts who need a unified platform to track Instagram performance and optimize their content across various channels.

These tools and APIs help creators, businesses, and marketers on YouTube and Instagram analyze performance, engage with their audiences, and optimize their content strategy.